

own. Context is king. You cannot create the experience, but you have a say in forming the context. Most importantly, good UX design ensures that using the product has meaning to the user, which will only happen if they form an emotional connection, which in turn will only happen if every aspect of the design is rooted in the rationale and needs of your users. Read Chapter 3 to understand how to understand the user's needs and rationale. If we compare a user using a product (to achieve a goal) to a road trip, we can metaphorically say the following:

Usability is about making the journey short, smooth and as straight as possible.

UI design is about putting display screens on the windows and windshield so that the journey looks awesome (maybe even going through a wormhole..).

UX design is about making sure you have fun during the journey, by showing you whatever you would like to see, and letting you choose which road you want to take, be it a plain highway or winding mountain pass. (For consistency, imagine it was a self-driving driving, thought controlled car.)

Assembling a UX Design

Much like a Desktop PC, a great UX design can be assembled from a few high quality components. These are:

1. Psychology: Your users are people, and people have complex minds. Being a person yourself, you should know! Since you are designing for their subjective experience, you have to focus on their needs, their motivations and their expectations, every step of the way. Consider their level of prior knowledge, and keep in your mind a representation of what would be on their mind. Use this to see how you can condition them or form habits. Above all, make sure you are designing according to their psychology, not yours!

2. Usability: This aspect will be readily apparent to your users, especially if the design is confusing and hard to use. Don't use your own logic, try to mimic the user's intuition such that even an unnamed ignorant celebrity could use it. Try to pre-empt user-made mistakes and plan your design around them. Give the user as little to do as possible without taking away control or interest. Use conventions and conform to widely adopted standards if that is what the user subconsciously expects. Lastly, base all your decisions on solid research (as you will learn in the coming chapters) and not your own logic!